ASSETS · AI

What an API is

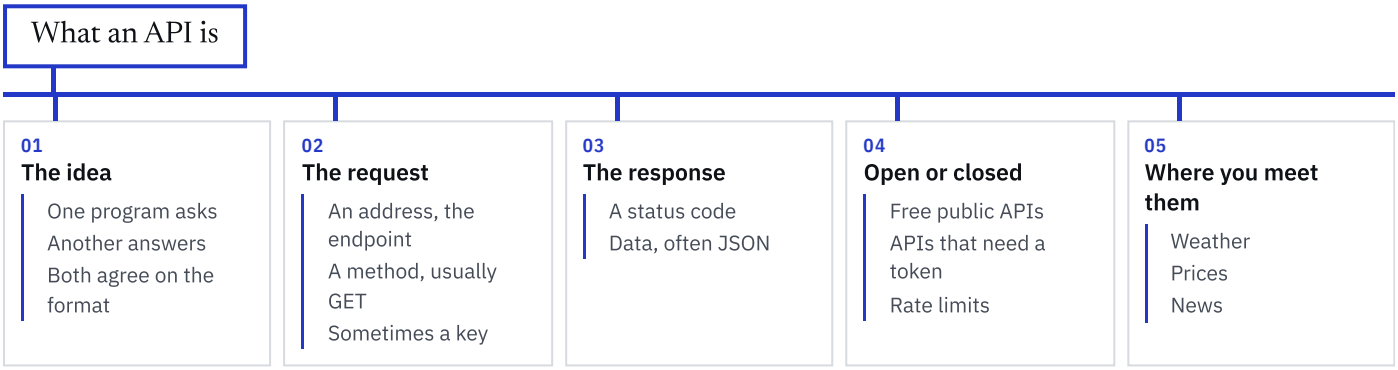
How one program asks another for data, in plain words.

PLANNED

What you will learn

An API is a way for one program to ask another for something and get an answer back in a format both understand. When a weather app shows tomorrow's rain, it asked a weather service through an API. This piece explains the idea in plain words: a request goes to an address, and the answer comes back, often as JSON, a simple text format of names and values. You will learn the few words you keep seeing (endpoint, request, response, status code, key) and why some APIs are open to anyone while others need a token.

Map of the piece



Sources

1 **Introduction to web APIs**
MDN, Mozilla, 2026
developer.mozilla.org

2 **Overview of HTTP**
MDN, Mozilla, 2026
developer.mozilla.org

3 **RFC 8259: The JavaScript Object Notation (JSON) Data Interchange Format**
T. Bray (ed.), IETF, 2017
rfc-editor.org

Each source was opened and checked on 14 October 2026. The finished piece may add more.